

How to Download and Install Visual Studio Code (VS Code)

What is Visual Studio Code?

Visual Studio Code (VS Code) is a free and popular code editor used to write programs. It is mostly used for JavaScript and web development.

Why VS Code is Better Than Notepad

Notepad is a basic text editor. You can write JavaScript in it, but it has no helpful features.

VS Code and other IDEs (like Eclipse or IntelliJ) are better because:

- They show your code in color (this is called syntax highlighting).
- They suggest code as you type (auto-complete).
- You can run and check your code in the same place.
- They show errors while you're typing.
- They support extensions for more features.

Feature	Notepad	VS Code / IDEs
Code Coloring	No	Yes
Auto-Complete	No	Yes
Run Code Easily	No (need CMD)	Yes (built-in terminal)
Show Errors Early	No	Yes
File Navigation	Manual	Easy project explorer

Example Using Notepad

1. Open Notepad and type:

```
console.log("Hello from Notepad!");
```

2. Save the file as `notepadExample.js` in your **Documents** folder.
3. Open **Command Prompt** and type:

```
cd Documents
node notepadExample.js
```

4. Output:

```
Hello from Notepad!
```

Problems with Notepad:

- It doesn't help with auto-complete or error checking.
 - You need to switch between Notepad and CMD.
 - It's easy to make mistakes, like saving the file with the wrong name or extension.
-

How to Download and Install VS Code

1. Open your browser and search: Download Visual Studio Code.
 2. Visit the official website: <https://code.visualstudio.com/>
 3. Download the version for your computer (Windows, macOS, or Linux).
 4. Run the downloaded file and follow the steps to install.
-

Getting Started with VS Code

1. Open VS Code.
 2. On the left side, you'll see icons for:
 - **Explorer:** See and open your files.
 - **Search:** Find something in your code.
 - **Source Control:** Connect to Git or GitHub.
 - **Run and Debug:** Test your code inside VS Code.
 - **Extensions:** Add more features or language support.
-

Create Your First JavaScript File in VS Code

1. Click the **Explorer** icon on the left.
2. Click **Open Folder** and go to **Documents**.
3. Create a folder called `javascriptpractice` and open it.
4. Create a new file and name it `MyFirstJavascript.js`.
5. Write this code:

```
console.log("Hello, Playwright!");
```

Run JavaScript Code in VS Code

1. Click on the top menu: **Terminal > New Terminal**.
2. The terminal will open at the bottom. Make sure you are in the correct folder:

```
C:\Users\yogesh\Documents\javascriptpractice>
```

3. Type and run:

```
node MyFirstJavascript.js
```

4. Output:

```
Hello, Playwright!
```

Using Console Methods in JavaScript

Try this in your file:

```
console.log("This is a regular message");  
console.warn("This is a warning message");  
console.error("This is an error message");
```

In VS Code terminal, they will all look the same. But in the browser, they look different.

To test in browser console:

1. Open Chrome and press **F12** to open Developer Tools.
2. Go to the **Console** tab.
3. Paste the same code there.

You will see:

- `console.log()`: Normal message
 - `console.warn()`: Yellow warning
 - `console.error()`: Red error
-

Final Summary

- **Notepad** is simple, but it does not help much for programming.
 - **VS Code** is free, smart, and easy to use for writing JavaScript.
 - You can write, run, and debug your code in one place using VS Code.
 - Console methods (`log`, `warn`, `error`) are useful for checking your code output.
-